Agentic Pilot: An Evidence-Driven Local Autonomous AI Agent Framework for Privacy-Preserving Intelligent Task Automation

***Abstract*—Browser agents can report a task as finished when it is not, and many send every observation to a hosted model. Agentic Pilot is an open-source browser agent with local models that may report completion only when a rule-based predicate over the observed page holds, storing the inputs of each decision as evidence. We formalize this evidence-gated completion and its false completion and false rejection rates. *Measured at component level*, in the agent's real verification node (called directly, with stubbed I/O), on 42 held-out states frozen before testing the gate withheld 9 of 22 unsatisfied states (0.23–0.61) and rejected 1 of 20 satisfied ones (exact McNemar on paired correct decisions $p = 0.021$ against a dispatch-only rule), against 20 of 23 on the states its rules were fixed on, because its checks are keyed to request wording. A decision on the constructed states costs a median of 27 ms and no model call. Privacy is meant in a narrow sense: by default the model client refuses non-loopback endpoints (an explicit override lifts this), and in 70 episodes with a scripted stand-in for the model server the agent's Python processes connected only to that stand-in on 127.0.0.1, which does not show where a real model server sends requests. Memory retrieval has no relevance threshold, and recovery does not recognize a missing confirmation. *In a seeded simulation* built on these measurements and stated assumptions, the configuration with the gate ended in fewer false completions (19 against 28 of 100 synthetic scenarios, a direction fixed by construction) and its decision accuracy did not differ significantly from accepting every claim (52 against 46 of 74 synthetic claims, $p = 0.15$); these values follow from the assumptions of a simulation model revised post hoc, after its first results were known, and are not measurements of the agent. *No end-to-end evaluation with a language model was executed*; its harness is released.**

***Index Terms*—LLM agents, web agents, local inference, data locality, completion verification, task automation, human-in-the-loop**

I. Introduction

Language-model agents now operate software for people: they open pages, fill in forms and read results [1]–[3]. Many send each observation, often a screenshot of a logged-in page, to a hosted multimodal model [2], [4], [5], although such screens carry names, messages and account data and personal information has been shown to leak from language models [6]. Independently of where the model runs, an agent can stop too early. We call this *premature completion*: a terminal "done" while the environment does not satisfy the goal, for example after opening the search engine but before issuing the query. Each action succeeded; the task did not.

a) Research gaps: We address three gaps, each stated so that it can be tested.

G1 *In-loop completion checks are rarely measured.* Benchmarks check the final state after the episode [1], [3], and judges assess saved trajectories [2], [7]; when the agent itself decides, it is usually its own model that does so [5], [8], and intrinsic self-correction is unreliable [9]. Whether a rule over observed state inside the loop withholds premature completions, and at what false-rejection cost, has not been reported with intervals and held-out data. Test: Sections VII-A and VIII-A.

G2 *The contribution of each kind of evidence is unknown.* If every conjunct of such a rule contributes, removing it should raise false completions. Test: the ablation of Section VIII-B.

G3 *Locality claims of local agents are rarely checked.* Running models locally is claimed to keep data on the machine, but whether an agent's process contacts other hosts is seldom measured. Test: the egress test of Section VIII-D.

b) Scope and terms: Agentic Pilot acts only in a Chromium browser. It is *autonomous* in that, given a request, it plans and executes browser actions without step-by-step instructions; the user approves tasks classified as high-risk (posting, sending, purchasing, deleting, transferring) and solves CAPTCHAs. It is *privacy-preserving* in a narrow sense: by default its model client sends prompts and screenshots only to a model server on the loopback interface, and it writes task records, memory and evidence only to local files (Section XI); whether that server runs inference locally depends on its configuration. Desktop, file and process control is a design (Appendix A).

c) Research questions: The gaps lead to five research questions and hypotheses H1–H5 (Section VI).

d) Scientific contributions:

1) A formulation of evidence-gated completion that separates action dispatch from task completion, with false completion and false rejection rates (Section III).
2) ACTUAL evidence on G1 and G2: the gate's error rates on 92 constructed states in three sets, one frozen before testing, inside the live verification node, with intervals, paired tests and a per-conjunct ablation. Rule fixes made on design states transfer only partially (Section VIII).
3) A seeded simulation (SYNTHETIC) of H1–H5, with inputs measured on the implementation and every assumed value stated, which shows under those assumptions the trade-off between false completions and false rejections;

measurements made for it (ACTUAL) show that memory retrieval has no relevance threshold and that recovery does not recognize a missing confirmation (Section IX).

e) Engineering contributions:

4) An open-source local agent with the gate inside its control loop (Algorithm 1, Section IV) and an implementation audit (Table II).
5) Enforcement of a loopback-only model endpoint and an ACTUAL test, with a stand-in model server, that the agent's Python processes connect only to loopback addresses, partially addressing G3 (Sections V and VIII-D).
6) An end-to-end harness: self-hosted sites with fictional content, 40 tasks with a dev/test split, an oracle validated on scripted trajectories, and baseline and ablation configurations (Section VII-B).

We do not claim that the agent completes tasks: the end-to-end evaluation is implemented but not run (Section VIII-E), and simulated results are labelled as such throughout.

II. Related Work

a) Reasoning-and-acting agents: ReAct interleaves reasoning with tool actions [8], building on chain-of-thought prompting [10]; Toolformer learns when to call an API [11]. Reflexion and RCI let the model critique and retry its own attempts [12], [13], and Voyager accumulates skills checked by a model [14]. In all of these a model decides that a task is finished, and intrinsic self-correction without external feedback does not reliably help [9].

b) Web and computer-use agents and benchmarks: Mind2Web pairs a ranker over Document Object Model (DOM) elements with an LLM [15]; WebVoyager drives live sites from screenshots [2]; SeeAct finds grounding to be the bottleneck [4], which Set-of-Mark prompting addresses [16]. WebArena, VisualWebArena and WorkArena evaluate on self-hosted or remote-hosted applications with functional checks [1], [17], [18]; OSWorld and Windows Agent Arena do so in real operating systems [3], [19]. UFO, Agent S and AppAgent control desktop and mobile applications [5], [20], [21], and CogAgent, SeeClick, UI-TARS and OmniParser ground actions in screenshots [22]–[25]. These works say little about when the agent itself may conclude that a task is done.

c) Completion checking: Benchmark checkers run after the episode. WebVoyager evaluates trajectories with a multimodal judge [2], Pan et al. use model-based evaluators to judge and refine agents [7], and Sumyk and Kosovan train a completion judge for macOS applications [26]. We study a rule over observed state *inside* the loop, record its inputs, and measure its errors (G1, G2); a model judge is complementary.

d) Memory, security and local inference: Retrieval-augmented generation [27], [28], Generative Agents and MemGPT [29], [30] manage agent memory. Indirect prompt injection hides instructions in content the agent reads [31]; defenses are insufficient in systematic evaluations [32], InjecAgent, AgentDojo, ToolEmu and OS-Harm measure unsafe behavior [33]–[36], and CaMeL separates trusted control flow from untrusted data [37]. Open-weight models such as Qwen2.5 and Qwen2-VL [38], [39] are released in sizes that, with 4-bit quantization [40], run on consumer hardware; surveys list trustworthiness among open problems of LLM agents [41], [42]. Table I compares representative systems.

TABLE I

COMPARISON WITH REPRESENTATIVE SYSTEMS, FROM WHAT EACH PAPER REPORTS. ENV.: W LIVE WEBSITES, WR SELF-HOSTED OR CACHED PAGES, WS SIMULATED WEB, TOOL OR TEXT ENVIRONMENT, D DESKTOP OS, MO MOBILE. EXEC.: A AGENT, B BENCHMARK, M MODEL. COMPLETION: WHO DECIDES THAT A TASK IS DONE—THE AGENT'S MODEL, A BENCHMARK CHECKER AFTER THE EPISODE, A MODEL JUDGE AFTER THE EPISODE, OR A RULE OVER OBSERVED STATE INSIDE THE LOOP; N/A IF THE SYSTEM DOES NOT END TASKS. EVID.: PERSISTS PER-STEP STATE ARTIFACTS. MEM.: MEMORY ACROSS STEPS OR EPISODES. DEPLOY.: L OPEN-WEIGHT MODELS USED OR SUPPORTED, H HOSTED MODELS ONLY. EVAL.: E2E END-TO-END TASKS, OFF OFFLINE STEP PREDICTION, C+S COMPONENT TESTS AND SIMULATION. Y YES, P PARTIAL, N NO, N.R. NOT REPORTED. ALL LISTED SYSTEMS RELEASED CODE.

System	Env.	Exec.	Completion	Evid.	Mem.	Deploy.	Eval.
ReAct [8]	Ws	A	model	N	N	H	E2E
Reflexion [12]	Ws	A	model[a]	N	Y	H	E2E
WebArena [1]	Wr	B	benchmark	n.r.	N	H	E2E
Mind2Web [15]	Wr	B	n/a	P	N	L	Off
WebVoyager [2]	W	A	model; judge[b]	Y	N	H	E2E
SeeAct [4]	W, Wr	A	model	n.r.	N	P	E2E, Off
OSWorld [3]	D	B	benchmark	n.r.	N	L	E2E
UFO [5]	D	A	model	n.r.	P	H	E2E
AppAgent [21]	Mo	A	model	n.r.	Y	H	E2E
CogAgent [22]	Wr, Mo	M	n/a	N	N	L	Off
MemGPT [30]	Ws	A	n/a	N	Y	H	E2E[e]
AgentDojo [34]	Ws	B	benchmark	n.r.	N	L	E2E
Agentic Pilot (ours)	Wr[c]	A	in-loop rule	Y	P[d]	L	C+S

[a] An evaluator gives feedback between trials. [b] Used for evaluation. [c] Evaluated only on constructed states and self-hosted sites; the implemented backend targets live websites, and a desktop backend is designed (Appendix A). [d] Implemented; retrieval measured on 10 queries over a synthetic corpus, effect on tasks studied only by simulation. [e] Document QA and conversation tasks, not web tasks.

III. Problem Formulation

a) Dispatch and completion: The agent observes an environment state s_t through an observation $\Omega(s_t)$ (for the browser: URL, title, element list and screenshot). A planner maps a goal g, a plan $P = (g_1, \ldots, g_n)$ and the observation to an action a_t. Executing it returns a *dispatch flag* $\alpha_t \in \{0, 1\}$, which says only that the call returned without error. The agent may report the task complete only when a completion predicate holds on the state observed *after* the action:

$$\Phi(g, s_{t+1}, P, \sigma) = \textstyle\bigwedge_{c \in C(g,P)} c(s_{t+1}) \wedge \pi(P) \wedge \neg\beta(s_{t+1}, \sigma), \quad (1)$$

where $C(g, P)$ is the set of postconditions that the goal and plan imply, $\pi(P)$ states that no plan step is pending, and β is a blocking condition (a bot-check page, an unapproved high-risk action) with σ the approval state. Dispatch does not imply completion, $\alpha_t = 1 \not\Rightarrow \Phi = 1$. Every evaluation of Φ is stored with the observed values it used. The same form applies to desktop, file and process state, whose postconditions are

typed and exact (Appendix A); only the browser instance is implemented.

b) The implemented browser predicate: $C(g, P)$ is derived from the wording of the request. Φ is the conjunction of: no browser-error URL, error or "not found" title, bot-check URL or title, or redirect to a sign-in page when the request names a URL that is not one (E); not still on a search engine's home page when a search, an extraction or a multi-step plan was requested (H); a results page carrying the query quoted in g (Q); the literal text that g asks to be entered present in an input, exactly if g says "exactly" (T); for extraction requests, an answer or structured extraction that mentions a content word of g (X); and, for multi-step plans, no pending step unless a structured extraction exists (R). Each conjunct is instantiated only when its trigger words occur, so for a request that triggers none, Φ reduces to $\neg E$. A pre-check implements β for bot-check pages and halts the task as BLOCKED. A plan step counts as done when an action other than `complete` dispatches during it. Φ has no tunable threshold: its operating point is fixed by the rules, so we characterize the trade-off between false completions and false rejections by removing conjuncts (Section VIII-B) rather than by a curve.

c) Metrics: Let $\mathcal{T}$ be a set of episodes or end states, $\mathcal{T}_c \subseteq \mathcal{T}$ those reported complete, and $\Phi^\star$ an oracle that shares no code or inputs with Φ (written by the same AI agent as Φ's fixes) (Section VII). With $N_{\mathrm{FC}} = |\{\tau \in \mathcal{T}_c : \Phi^\star(\tau) = 0\}|$ and $N_{\mathrm{FR}} = |\{\tau \in \mathcal{T} \setminus \mathcal{T}_c : \Phi^\star(\tau) = 1\}|$,

$$\mathrm{FCR} = \frac{N_{\mathrm{FC}}}{|\mathcal{T}_c|}, \quad \mathrm{FRR} = \frac{N_{\mathrm{FR}}}{|\{\tau \in \mathcal{T} : \Phi^\star(\tau) = 1\}|}. \quad (2)$$

Because a dispatch-only rule reports every state complete, we also report the share of unsatisfied states that the gate withholds, $1 - N_{\mathrm{FC}}/|\{\tau : \Phi^\star(\tau) = 0\}|$. FCR alone rewards an agent that never finishes, so the rates are always reported together, as counts with Wilson 95% intervals [43].

IV. ARCHITECTURE

Fig. 1 shows the components. A desktop client submits a natural-language task to a FastAPI service bound to the loopback interface. The task runner executes the control loop, checkpoints its state after every node and cancels tasks that exceed a wall-clock limit (5 min by default). Task events go to SQLite and to a read-only monitoring process.

A. Control Loop

The loop is a compiled LangGraph state machine with eleven nodes; Algorithm 1 gives its behavior. A typed state record carries the intent, the plan and step index, the observation, the planned action, the action history, retry and model-call counters, routing decisions and the status. Only the verification step can end a task as COMPLETED, and only when Φ holds (Fig. 2).

a) Planning: A small model parses the request into an intent (action, site, target, content, risk level). Requests with a connective or more than eight words are decomposed into steps with an action type and expected outcome. Each iteration, the planner sees the goal, the plan, the current observation and retrieved memory and returns one action. Deterministic rules then adjust it: exact-text requests are grounded to the best visible text field, repeated navigation becomes a failure, and plan steps that name clicking or extracting map to those actions.

b) Recovery, routing and memory: A failed action is retried through a fresh observation while the task's retry counter

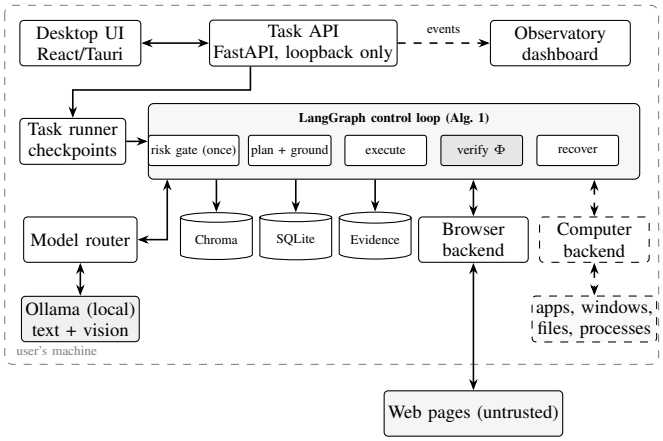


Fig. 1. Components of Agentic Pilot. Solid: implemented; dashed: proposed. Everything inside the boundary runs on the user's machine; the model endpoint must be a loopback address unless the user overrides it. The browser backend is the only implemented execution environment; the computer backend and the local resources it would act on are a design (Appendix A). The Observatory also reads the task database and evidence files.

Algorithm 1 Evidence-gated control loop (browser backend)

Require: goal g; budget of K=15 model calls
1: $I \leftarrow$ PARSEINTENT(g); $P \leftarrow$ DECOMPOSE(g) if multi-step
2: **if** I is high-risk and not approved **then return** WAITAPPROVAL
3: **end if**
4: NAVIGATE($I.site$); on failure go to line 14
5: **loop**
6: $o \leftarrow$ OBSERVE ▷ sanitized DOM, screenshot
7: **if** $\beta(o)$ **then return** BLOCKED ▷ hand off to user
8: **end if**
9: $a \leftarrow$ PLAN($g, P, o,$ RETRIEVE(g)) ▷ model call
10: $\alpha \leftarrow$ EXECUTE(a); save before/after evidence
11: **if** $\alpha = 0$ **then**
12: **if** fewer than 3 retries **then continue**
13: **end if**
14: *st* $\leftarrow$ RECOVER(error)
15: **if** *st* is blocked **then return** BLOCKED
16: **end if**
17: **if** *st* is exhausted **then return** FAILED
18: **end if**
19: **continue** ▷ retry, vision, ...
20: **end if**
21: **if** $a \neq$ `complete` **then** mark step done; **if** steps remain **continue**
22: **end if**
23: **if** $a =$ `complete` or last step or text typed **then**
24: $(v, \mathrm{obs}) \leftarrow \Phi(g, s, P)$; save as evidence
25: **if** v **then** store memory; **return** COMPLETED
26: **end if**
27: **end if**
28: **if** model calls $\geq K$ **then** go to line 14 ▷ budget failure enters recovery
29: **end if**
30: **end loop**

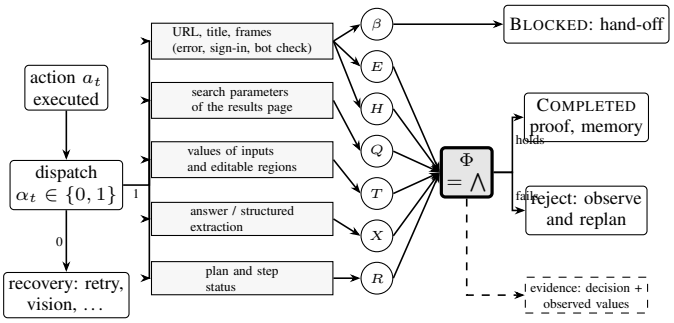


Fig. 2. Evidence-gated verification after an action (Algorithm 1, lines 7 and 24). A failed dispatch goes to recovery and never to Φ. A successful dispatch makes the observed values available to the conjuncts of the browser predicate, each triggered by the wording of the goal (Section III); the bot-check condition β is tested first and hands the task to the user. Every decision is stored with the values it used.

is below three; the counter is shared with the recovery engine and never reset, so these inline retries are a per-task budget. After them, failures are classified into seven types and assigned a strategy (retry, alternative selector, vision fallback, replan) until the counter reaches six, i.e. at most three engine attempts after the inline retries. Only the vision-fallback strategy changes behavior, by routing the next step to the vision model; the other strategies repeat ordinary planning. A deterministic router assigns each model call a role and the first installed candidate among local Qwen2.5, Qwen3.5 and DeepSeek-R1 models (1.5B–7B parameters), or `qwen3-vl:2b` and `moondream` for vision. At termination, outcomes are written to a local Chroma collection and retrieved into later planning prompts.

B. Browser Backend

A pool of Playwright contexts over one Chromium instance gives each task its own page. Each observation is a DOM pass over interactable elements, recording tag, role, label, up to 120 characters of text, type, visibility, bounding box and selectors; elements are ranked, deduplicated and capped at 50, and their text is passed through a prompt-injection sanitizer. Actions are navigate, click, type, key press, scroll and extract; typed text is read back. The vision model is used only when the planner returns `need_help` or recovery requests it: it receives a screenshot and returns a point, which is clicked without an individual check. Per task, the evidence directory holds before/after screenshots of each action, the latest DOM manifest, the verification and recovery records and the node trace.

V. IMPLEMENTATION

The backend is Python (about 11,000 lines) on FastAPI, LangGraph, Playwright and Pydantic, with SQLite and a persistent local Chroma store; model calls use the Ollama HTTP API with JSON output and a fixable temperature and seed. The client is React in a Tauri shell. The code is public under the MIT license at https://github.com/sudeshsudhii/Agentic-pilot-local; this paper describes branch `ccr-4b8200f0-5i3k5m`, whose agent code (`backend/`) is unchanged since commit `bf0a8a5`; the experiment scripts, data and simulation are on the same branch. The repository's default branch has diverged (it defaults to a hosted model and adds desktop automation) and is not the version evaluated here; the evaluated version of the paper's artifacts is the head of that branch at submission, to be fixed by a release tag.

TABLE II
IMPLEMENTATION AUDIT, TRACED THROUGH THE CODE. CLASS: IE IMPLEMENTED AND EXPERIMENTALLY EVALUATED (COMPONENT LEVEL, ACTUAL); IS IMPLEMENTED, STUDIED ONLY BY SIMULATION; IN IMPLEMENTED, NOT EVALUATED; PI PARTIALLY IMPLEMENTED; PR PROPOSED. EVIDENCE: C COMPONENT STUDY, O ORACLE VALIDATION, E EGRESS TEST WITH A STAND-IN MODEL SERVER, T UNIT TEST, M MEASURED INPUT TO THE SIMULATION, S SIMULATION.

Component	Class	Evidence
Completion predicate Φ, bot-check halt	IE	C (92 states), M, S
Browser control (Playwright), DOM extraction	IE	C, M (latency)
Loopback-only model endpoint; Chroma telemetry off	IE	E (destinations, 70 stand-in episodes), T (refusal, telemetry flag)
End-to-end oracle $\Phi^\star$	IE	O (114 trajectories)
End-to-end harness (run with a language model)	IN	E (stand-in only)
Recovery engine: classification, strategy order	IE	C (6 failure modes), S
Memory store retrieval (Chroma, SQLite)	IE	C (10 queries, synthetic corpus), S
Per-action evidence (screenshots, records)	IS	M (latency), S
LLM planner in the full loop	IN	tests with mocked model
Vision fallback; task-level human approval	IN	tests
Recovery: alternative selector, replan	PI	labels only
Self-verification baseline mode	IN	harness only
Enhanced validation; evidence-guided recovery; memory relevance filter	PR	S (assumed behaviour)
Desktop backend, action gate, permission tiers	PR	–

a) Component audit: Agent documentation tends to run ahead of the code, so we traced each component to the code path that executes it and to the tests and experiments that exercise it (Table II). Claims in this paper are restricted to rows with evidence in the last column; the other rows are implemented but unevaluated, or designs.

b) Fixes: The audit and the gate study led to fixes. At commit `2361d50`, the extraction handler formatted every answer as facts about one university campus and substituted fixed text when a page had too few matching lines; it now keeps only page lines that share terms with the goal. The verification node accepted the reasoning of any action as an answer and let a `complete` action mark a pending step done; both are fixed, and the Q, sign-in and "not found" checks, exact matching and goal-term overlap were added. Bot-check detection no longer fires on titles that contain "robot" or on hidden frames. The vision-fallback strategy, memory retrieval and the verification switch were inert and now take effect; routing keywords match whole words. The repository's earlier "certification" figures counted a task as passed when it ended as completed and a screenshot existed, and we use none of them.

c) Locality enforcement: The model client refuses any endpoint whose host is not a loopback address

(127.0.0.0/8, `::1`) or a `localhost` name (accepted without DNS resolution), before connecting, unless the user sets `PILOT_ALLOW_REMOTE_MODEL=true`; LAN, link-local and unspecified addresses count as remote. The check applies to the configured address, not to the model name or proxy settings. Chroma stores are created with telemetry disabled, and the privacy audit log classifies destinations by parsed host instead of by substring. For experiments we added switches that replace Φ by no check or by a self-check of the planner model, remove single conjuncts, or pin one recovery strategy, and the gateway records the token counts that Ollama reports.

VI. Research Questions and Hypotheses

The gaps of Section I lead to five research questions: does evidence-gated completion reduce false completions (RQ1, G1) and make completion decisions more reliable (RQ2, G1–G2); does memory improve consistency on repeated workflows (RQ3); does evidence-guided recovery improve recovery (RQ4); and what does verification cost (RQ5)? Table III states the corresponding hypotheses. At the level of the full agent each is examined here only in simulation (Section VII-C), which cannot test it but shows what it implies under stated assumptions; H1 and H2 also have ACTUAL component-level evidence from the gate study: on held-out 2 the gate withholds 9 of 22 premature completions and is correct on 28 of 42 states against 20 of 42 for a dispatch-only rule ($p = 0.021$; Section VIII-A). H5 has ACTUAL latency evidence, and the inputs of H3 and H4 are ACTUAL measurements of the memory store and the recovery engine. *None is confirmed empirically end to end*; the protocol of Section VII-B is that test. For H4 and the enhanced variant of H2 the simulated outcome follows directly from the assumed behaviour of unimplemented components, so their synthetic p-values carry no information beyond those assumptions.

TABLE III
HYPOTHESES WITH NULL (H_0) AND ALTERNATIVE (H_1) FORMS. CONTROLS FOR ALL: SAME SCENARIOS, PLANNER BEHAVIOUR, BUDGET AND SEEDS. TEST: EXACT MCNEMAR ON PAIRED SCENARIO OUTCOMES, WILSON INTERVALS, MONTE CARLO OVER REGENERATED SETS. LAST COLUMN: SYNTHETIC OUTCOME IN THE SIMULATION (V2, REVISED POST HOC) (SECTION IX); IT IS NOT AN EMPIRICAL RESULT. COMPONENT-LEVEL ACTUAL EVIDENCE BEARING ON H1/H2 (SECTION VIII-A): ON HELD-OUT 2 THE GATE WITHHOLDS 9 OF 22 UNSATISFIED STATES AND REJECTS 1 OF 20 SATISFIED ONES (EXACT MCNEMAR AGAINST DISPATCH-ONLY $p = 0.021$); IT CONCERNS CONSTRUCTED STATES, NOT AGENT EPISODES.

	H_1 (H_0: no difference)	IV	DV	Simulated outcome
H1	Evidence-gated verification lowers false completions vs. accepting every claim	Φ on / off	FC per scenario, FCR	lower by construction; size 19 vs 28 FC (cond.)
H2	Evidence validation raises decision reliability	Φ on / off; enhanced	decision accuracy	component (ACTUAL): 28 vs 20 of 42 correct, p=0.021; simulation: no significant difference at n=74 (.70 vs .62, p=0.15 cond.), 2 of 3 false rejections from assumed missing evidence; enhanced: follows from assumed rates, no evidence
H3	Memory raises contextual consistency on repeated workflows	memory off / on / filtered	TSR on repeated workflows	uninformative; underpowered (19 vs 19 of 44)
H4	Evidence-guided recovery recovers more failures than retry	recovery mode	recovered share	higher by assumption (87 vs 68 of 93; proposed)
H5	Verification adds overhead and makes decisions more conservative	verifier	time, FRR	Φ 5.2–26.8 ms (ACTUAL); episode +2.6% mean; decision FRR 3/46 vs 0/46 (cond.)

VII. Evaluation Methodology

Three evaluations are reported, with different scope: (i) component-level ACTUAL measurements on the implementation without a language model (gate study, ablation, latency, retrieval ranks, recovery classification, 70 control-loop episodes with a scripted stand-in model for the egress test, and 114 scripted trajectories for oracle validation); (ii) a seeded SYNTHETIC simulation of the full agent built on those measurements and stated assumptions; (iii) an end-to-end protocol with a language model, implemented but not executed. Only (iii) would validate the full agent; (i) validates components and (ii) shows what the components imply under the assumptions. The component experiments need no language model. The current-code results were produced on 2026-10-04 on a Linux container with a 4-core Intel Xeon at 2.1 GHz, 15 GiB RAM and no GPU, with Python 3.11.15, Playwright 1.56.0, headless Chromium 141, LangGraph 1.2.12 and Chroma 1.5.9 (all package versions pinned in `requirements-paper.lock`); the decisions of the code before the fixes come from runs on a similar container (2026-09-30 to 2026-10-01) of the study script against the agent code of commit `08653e2`, checked out separately, and are deterministic. Scripts, seeds and raw outputs are under `artifacts/` and `benchmarks/e2e/` in the repository.

A. Gate Study

a) States and splits: A state is a goal, a URL, an HTML document served through Playwright request interception, the agent's answer and plan state where relevant, and an oracle label. Every state ends with a dispatched action, so a dispatch-only rule accepts all of them. The *design* set (38 states in six categories) was used to find the gate's defects and design the fixes. *Held-out 1* (12 states) was written after the fixes and not used to change them. *Held-out 2* (42 states, 22 unsatisfied) was written to a fixed procedure—varied user phrasings per category, including wordings the gate's trigger lists do not contain, with a balanced split—and committed before the gate was run on it; the gate was then run on a working tree committed as `55ac1ea`, which adds to the frozen gate code only configuration switches for the ablation, a separate self-verification baseline method, the loopback endpoint check and extra logging; none of them is on by default or changes

the gate's default decisions (diff `b9d5088..55ac1ea`). Its SHA-256 is recorded in the repository.

b) Locality test: The 10 development tasks were run under 7 configurations through `run_e2e.py` against a scripted stand-in for the Ollama API (`fake_ollama.py`, 127.0.0.1:11435), with `benchmarks/e2e/egress` on the Python path so that its `sitecustomize` module logs every socket connection attempt to the file named by `PILOT_EGRESS_LOG`. The raw log, the episode records, the configurations and the reconstructed command are released in `artifacts/results/e2e_smoke_stub`, and `summarize_egress.py` rebuilds the summary.

c) Oracle: The label $\Phi^\star$ of a state states whether the goal is achieved by the page and answer shown, judged from the page's facts (for example, whether the answer contains the year in the article). It was written together with the state, before the state was judged by the gate, and it is computed by no code shared with Φ. Its limitation is that all states and labels were written by the AI agent that also designed the gate fixes (Acknowledgment) and no person or second annotator has relabelled them, so no inter-annotator agreement exists; a protocol for independent relabelling with Cohen's κ [44] is in the repository.

d) Modes and statistics: Each state is judged by the pre-check and Φ called directly, and by the real verification node (database, browser-pool and evidence I/O stubbed) with an empty or a generic one-sentence planner reasoning. For the ablation, each conjunct of Φ is removed in turn by a configuration switch, and the pre-check β is skipped by an argument of the study script; the ablation runs on the predicate called directly. Counts carry Wilson and Clopper–Pearson 95% intervals [43], [45]; comparisons on the same states use the exact McNemar test [46] on paired decision correctness. Against the dispatch-only rule the discordant pairs are the withheld unsatisfied states (only the gate is correct) and the rejected satisfied states (only dispatch is correct); an earlier version tested the withheld count alone and is corrected here. Latency is the median of 20 repetitions after a warm-up.

B. End-to-End Harness

a) Environment and tasks: Live websites change and block automated traffic, and WebArena-style site images were not available offline, so we built five self-hosted sites served on the loopback interface with fictional content that a model cannot answer from memory: a search engine, an encyclopedia, a shop with search and cart, a town-office contact form and newsletter, and a notes application; a further path redirects to a sign-in wall. The 40 tasks (10 development, 30 test) cover search, navigation, text entry, extraction, form submission, multi-step tasks and 5 unsatisfiable requests, at four difficulty tiers by the number of actions a solution needs (1, 2–3, 4–6, more). The notes site appears only in the test split. Tasks needing an account, payment, a CAPTCHA, the live web, or an outcome that neither server state nor answer text can verify were excluded by design. Because the search-home check H recognizes only public search engines, it never fires on these sites; its ablation in the harness is uninformative.

b) Oracle: $\Phi^\star$ is computed from signals that neither the agent nor Φ uses: server-side records of the sites (cart contents, form submissions, saved notes, field values autosaved by page scripts), the final URL, and the ground-truth facts in the site data matched against the agent's answer; unsatisfiable tasks are never achieved. It calls no model and shares no code with the verifier. We measured its error rate on 114 scripted trajectories driven directly through Playwright without the agent: a correct solution for each task, an idle trajectory that only opens the start page, and a near miss for 34 tasks (wrong value, wrong item, extra submission, partial query).

c) Protocol: Table XV (Appendix B) lists the configurations: the full system, two baselines—(a) no completion check and (b) self-verification by the planner model—and one-factor ablations of each conjunct, memory, recovery and each recovery strategy. Each configuration runs in its own process with its own database and memory store, at temperature 0 with a fixed seed, three trials per task, and the same budget of 15 planner calls (after which the recovery engine may grant its remaining attempts). Per episode the harness records the oracle verdict, the agent's status, browser actions, model calls and tokens, wall-clock time, each verification decision with its latency, recovery strategies, retrieved memories, Ollama version and model digests, and the host of every page request Playwright reports. The analysis reports success, FCR and FRR with Wilson intervals, per-category breakdowns, exact McNemar tests and task-level bootstrap intervals [47] for differences to the full system, and the overhead of Φ relative to baseline (a). A published agent framework as a third baseline would need its own model and prompts and is outside the scope of this paper.

C. Simulation-Based Evaluation and Data Provenance

a) Why simulation: The end-to-end protocol needs local model weights, which the environment used for this paper could not download. A simulation is appropriate for the remaining questions because the quantities they depend on separate into component behaviour that we can measure without a model (detection and false-rejection rates of Φ, latencies, the engine's classification, retrieval ranks) and planner behaviour that we cannot; propagating the first through the control flow of the loop, while sweeping the second, shows which unmeasured parameters decide H1–H5. We built such a seeded simulation (`benchmarks/simulation`). The simulation does not execute the agent. Its outputs follow from measured and assumed inputs. Every number in this paper belongs to one of six classes: ACTUAL (genuinely executed or measured on the implementation), SYNTHETIC (produced by the simulation), ASSUMED (an input value chosen by us, not measured), DERIVED (computed from existing results, e.g. a rate estimated from actual counts), LITERATURE (taken from cited work), or PROPOSED (behaviour of a component that is not implemented, or an evaluation not yet done). Tables and figures state the class of their values in the caption or

row label; in the text, numbers in Sections VIII and XI are ACTUAL unless stated, and numbers in Section IX are SYNTHETIC unless marked otherwise. An evidence ledger lists every simulated value in the main tables with its source and class.

b) Measured inputs: Without a model we measured, on the implementation (2026-10-23, 4-core Intel Xeon at 2.8 GHz, same software versions): the decisions of Φ and of a basic success detector (error check E only) on the 92 gate states; the latency of navigation, clicks, form filling, DOM extraction, screenshots and Φ on the self-hosted sites (30 repetitions each); the failure class and strategy sequence that the real recovery engine assigns to six failure messages; and the ranks at which the real Chroma memory store returns relevant records for ten queries over a 22-record synthetic memory corpus. Detection rates used by the simulation are derived from the two held-out gate sets only (for detection, the 22 unsatisfied states left after the bot-check category is excluded, 18 from held-out 2 and 4 from held-out 1; the 24 satisfied states of the same categories for false rejection), with the estimator $(k+0.5)/(n+1)$, which gives a small nonzero rate (0.07–0.13) where none was observed, as for basic detection in five categories and Φ on extraction, and turns the 0 of 24 false rejections into 0.02. Simulated categories map to gate categories as follows: navigation, search, extraction and multi-step to themselves, data entry to text entry, and form submission to text entry and multi-step pooled. The detection rate of a missing confirmation is proxied by the multi-step rate (an assumed proxy; 3 states), and the category mapping above is likewise assumed.

c) Assumptions and generation: What needs a model—how often the planner claims completion of an unfinished task, how often actions fail and are recovered, how much memory helps—is assumed and listed with its class in Table XVI (Appendix C). A *claim* in the simulation stands for any point at which the code evaluates Φ: a `complete` action, any successful action on the last plan step (for a request that is not decomposed, every successful action), or the typing of requested exact text; π is the probability that such a point is reached while the task is unfinished. A scenario has a task category (navigation, search, form submission, data entry, extraction, multi-step) and an outcome class (successful, incomplete, incorrect action, missing evidence, contradictory evidence, stale evidence, ambiguous) that sets the probability that the goal is actually met. Each scenario draws its random numbers once, and every configuration reuses them, so comparisons are paired by scenario. The true outcome is evaluated per configuration because memory and continuation after a rejection change the final state. For v1, parameters and code were committed (`3a0aa8e`) before the held-out set (seed 202, 100 scenarios) was generated; the reported results come from the post-hoc v2 described below; a development set (seed 101) was used only to debug the code. After the freeze, one function was changed: the latency model (Study F) did not give all configurations the same random draws, so it was corrected to common random numbers in `41a6097`; Studies A–E and H were not affected and gave identical outputs before and after. Later, `episode()` gained three output fields (claim, true state at the claim, first decision) for the decision-level analysis; outputs were otherwise byte-identical.

d) Corrected model (v2, post hoc): A methodology audit of the frozen model (v1) found that it contradicted the implementation in four places: its false-rejection rates came from bot-check pages, a category the scenarios do not contain; a rejected claim followed by a successful continuation was accepted without a second check, although the verification node checks every claim; the basic detector did not fail closed on an unreadable page, although it shares the error check E; and recovery was applied to every action failure, although action errors are first retried three times inline and a missing confirmation reaches the recovery engine only as a budget failure after 15 model calls. The results reported here come from a corrected model, v2 (`simulate_v2.py`), that fixes these four points, draws derived rates from their Beta posteriors in the Monte Carlo replications, adds re-planning to the latency model and sweeps the continuation rate. v2 reuses v1's generator, seeds, scenario set and assumed values. It was written after the v1 results were known and is therefore *not pre-registered*; the corrections moved the results for Φ in its favour (task success relative to no verification from 37 against 43, $p = 0.07$, to 44 against 46; decision accuracy from 45/71 against 43/71 to 52/74 against 46/74), mainly because v1's false-rejection rate (0.089) came from bot-check pages; v1's outputs are archived (`out/heldout_v1`) and every number that changed is listed in the statistical correction report (`artifacts/results/final_audit/`). Monte Carlo replications regenerate the scenario set 1,000 times and draw the derived rates from their posteriors, to show the variability the generator and the rate uncertainty induce; the assumed values and the recovery probabilities taken from Study E are held fixed, so the intervals omit their uncertainty.

e) Metrics: With TP, FP, FN, TN the confusion counts of reported completion against the true outcome over N scenarios: $\mathrm{TSR} = \mathrm{TP}/N$; FCR and FRR as in Eq. (2), so that precision $= 1 - \mathrm{FCR}$ and recall $= 1 - \mathrm{FRR}$; F1 and accuracy $(\mathrm{TP} + \mathrm{TN})/N$. Recovery success is recovered over recoverable failures; retrieval quality is precision and recall at $k = 3$ and the mean reciprocal rank (MRR) of the first relevant record. Episode time is decomposed as

$$T = T_{\mathrm{inf}} + T_{\mathrm{browser}} + T_{\mathrm{evidence}} + T_{\mathrm{verify}} + T_{\mathrm{recovery}}, \quad (3)$$

with browser, evidence and Φ times resampled from the measurements and inference time assumed. Two levels are kept apart. *Policy-level* outcomes describe how an episode ends (task success, episode-level false completion); *decision-level* outcomes describe whether the verifier's first decision on a completion claim matches the true state at that claim. Because a rejection can change how an episode ends, the final ground truth of a scenario may differ between configurations, so only the decision level compares verifiers against one shared truth. The decision-level outcome was defined after the v1 results were known, when an audit showed that the earlier accuracy

comparison mixed the two levels. Paired configurations are compared by the exact McNemar test on per-scenario binary indicators of one level, and the variability of paired differences across regenerated scenario sets by Monte Carlo percentiles. Every p-value and interval computed from synthetic data is conditional on the simulation assumptions; it describes the synthetic sample, not the deployed agent.

f) Studies: Study A generates the scenarios and computes the completion metrics, B compares four completion rules, C ablates components, D evaluates memory, E recovery, F overhead, G privacy (analytically, Section XI) and H sensitivity.

g) Validation by recomputation: For v1, a separate AI agent of the same authoring pipeline, given only the per-scenario output files, recomputed, with separately written code, the confusion counts, rates and paired tests of Studies B and C and the memory and recovery statistics from the per-scenario files, and found no discrepancy (`simulation_validation_report.md`). Monte Carlo, sensitivity, latency, decision-level and recovery paired-test values were not independently recomputed. This check is a recomputation of the analysis code's arithmetic from the same synthetic files; it is neither independent human annotation of any label nor an independent replication of an experiment. For v2, a final AI review agent of the same pipeline recomputed with separately written code the policy- and decision-level confusion counts, the paired tests and the recovery and memory values from the per-scenario files, reran the simulation and the table generator byte for byte, and found no discrepancy; Monte Carlo, sensitivity and latency values were checked only through that rerun; the recomputation scripts are in `artifacts/results/final_audit/scripts`. It also found that v2 first sent requests for help and failed navigations to the recovery engine without the retries the code makes; this was corrected before the values reported here.

VIII. Results

All results concern the browser backend and its components.

A. Completion Gate (G1)

Table IV reports the gate study. On the code before the fixes, the pre-check and Φ withheld 15 of the 23 unsatisfied design states and rejected 3 of the 15 satisfied ones; inside the live verification node they withheld only 14 (empty planner reasoning) or 13 (verbose reasoning), because the node let a premature `complete` mark a pending step done and took the planner's reasoning for an answer. After the fixes all three modes agree on every state of every set. On the design states the gate withholds 20 of 23 and rejects 1 of 15, and corrects 7 states relative to the earlier gate without breaking any; we report these counts without significance tests, because the fixes were designed on these states and a test of them would be circular.

The held-out sets give a less optimistic estimate. On held-out 2, frozen before testing, the gate withholds 9 of 22 unsatisfied states (0.41; 95% interval 0.23–0.61) and rejects 1 of 20 satisfied ones (0.05; 0.01–0.24), so it is correct alone on 9 states and wrong alone on 1 (exact McNemar $p = 0.021$); pooled with held-out 1, it withholds 11 of 27 (0.25–0.59) and rejects 2 of 27 (0.02–0.23; 11 against 2, $p = 0.022$). On held-out 1 alone (2 against 1; $p = 1.0$) the smallest attainable p with three discordant states is 0.25, so the test cannot show a difference. Its misses follow from the rules. The answer check X is triggered by words such as "extract" and "information about", so requests phrased "tell me", "what year", "find" or "get me" are not checked at all, and when X fires it accepts any answer that repeats a goal term ("Tokyo is the capital of Japan" for the population of Tokyo): none of the 5 unsatisfied extraction states is withheld. Text-entry requests phrased "write … in" or "fill … with" are not parsed; error pages titled "410 Gone" or "Something went wrong", a redirect to a different page, a press-and-hold human check, a results page for another query requested as "Google '…' ", and an add-to-cart click that added nothing all pass. The one false rejection is a page that merely mentions reCAPTCHA. Hand-written rules thus fix the cases they were written for and generalize only partially, which answers G1 with a qualified yes: the gate is correct on significantly more held-out states than a dispatch-only rule and withholds 41% of premature completions, with a false-rejection rate whose 95% upper bound is 0.24, but far fewer than on the states it was designed on.

TABLE IV

Completion gate on constructed end states. n^-/n^+: states that do not / do meet the goal under the oracle. W: unsatisfied states withheld (a dispatch-only rule withholds none); FR: satisfied states rejected; FC/R: false completions over states reported complete (FCR); it depends on the constructed share of unsatisfied states and is not an estimate for real use, unlike W/n^- and FR/n^+. Brackets: Wilson 95% intervals. p: exact McNemar test on paired decision correctness against the dispatch-only rule on the same states (discordant pairs: W states only the gate decides correctly, FR states only the dispatch-only rule does); it is not computed on the design set (–), because the rules were written on those states. Upper block: current gate by category; lower block: totals, including the gate before the fixes. Held-out 2 was frozen in a commit before the gate was run on it. Source: `GATE_STATS.CSV` (columns `P_CORRECT_VS_DISPATCH` and, for the gate before the fixes, `PRE_P_CORRECT_VS_DISPATCH`).

	Design (38 states)			Held-out 2 (42 states)		
Category	n^-/n^+	W	FR	n^-/n^+	W	FR
Search	4/3	4	0	3/3	2	0
Navigation	6/2	5	0	4/4	1	0
Bot check	4/2	3	0	4/2	3	1
Text entry	3/3	3	0	3/3	1	0
Extraction	4/3	4	1	5/5	0	0
Multi-step	2/2	1	0	3/3	2	0

Set	Gate	W / n^-	FR / n^+	FC/R	p
Design	before	15/23 [.45,.81]	3/15 [.07,.45]	8/20	–
Design	after	20/23 [.68,.95]	1/15 [.01,.30]	3/17	–
Held-out 1	before	1/5 [.04,.62]	1/7 [.03,.51]	4/10	1.0
Held-out 1	after	2/5 [.12,.77]	1/7 [.03,.51]	3/9	1.0
Held-out 2	after	9/22 [.23,.61]	1/20 [.01,.24]	13/32	0.021
Held-out 1+2	after	11/27 [.25,.59]	2/27 [.02,.23]	16/41	0.022

TABLE V

ABLATION OF THE GATE ON ALL 92 CONSTRUCTED STATES: FALSE COMPLETIONS (FC) AND FALSE REJECTIONS (FR) WITH ONE CONJUNCT OF Φ, OR THE BOT-CHECK HALT β, REMOVED. p: EXACT MCNEMAR TEST OF CORRECT DECISIONS AGAINST THE FULL GATE ON THE DESIGN STATES (PAIRED BY STATE); DESCRIPTIVE ONLY, SINCE THE CONJUNCTS WERE WRITTEN ON THESE STATES. ON THE HELD-OUT SETS NO REMOVAL CHANGES MORE THAN THREE DECISIONS. SOURCE: VERIFICATION_GATE_ABLATION.CSV.

	Design (23/15)			Held-out 1 (5/7)		Held-out 2 (22/20)	
Removed	FC	FR	p	FC	FR	FC	FR
none (full Φ)	3	1	–	3	1	13	1
E error, sign-in	8	1	0.063	4	1	14	1
H search home	7	1	0.13	3	1	15	1
Q query match	4	1	1.0	3	1	13	1
T typed text	6	1	0.25	3	1	14	1
X answer	6	0	0.63	3	1	13	1
R pending steps	4	1	1.0	3	1	15	1
β bot check	5	1	0.50	4	0	15	0

B. Contribution of Each Conjunct (G2)

Table V removes one conjunct at a time. On the design states every removal raises false completions, most for the error check E (3→8) and the search-home check H (3→7), but with 23 unsatisfied states no single removal changes more than five decisions, and with at most five discordant states the smallest attainable exact McNemar p is 0.063, so the test could not reach $p < 0.05$; this is not evidence that a conjunct is unnecessary. On the held-out sets each removal changes at most three decisions, and removing Q or X changes none: these conjuncts rarely fire on phrasings they were not written for. Only two removals trade false completions for false rejections: the bot-check halt β (held-out 2: 13→15 FC, 1→0 FR) and, on the design states, the answer check X (3→6 FC, 1→0 FR). Evidence types thus contribute on the states that trigger them, and the gate's coverage, not the strength of any single check, limits it.

C. Overhead

Φ makes no model call and no browser action; it reads the page through the browser protocol. Over the 83 decisions that evaluate Φ the median latency was 26.8 ms (90th percentile 29.5 ms, 95th 30.3 ms, maximum 34.6 ms; percentiles of per-state medians of 20 repetitions, which understate the tail of single decisions), and decisions stopped by the pre-check took at most 13.4 ms. Its added tokens and API cost are zero; the added steps that a rejection causes can only be measured end to end (Section VIII-E).

D. Locality (G3) and Oracle Validity

To test locality we ran 70 agent episodes (the 10 development tasks under 7 configurations, six with memory enabled) through the real control loop and Chromium against the local sites, with a scripted stand-in for the Ollama API on 127.0.0.1:11435, on an uncommitted working tree based on commit `1435fe9` (recorded in the run's metadata; the uncommitted changes were not saved, so the run cannot be tied exactly to the evaluated commit `bf0a8a5`, whose agent code differs from `1435fe9` in nine files). A `sitecustomize` module on the Python path logged every call to `socket.connect` and `connect_ex` on IPv4 and IPv6 sockets in the harness's eight Python processes (an orchestrator and one worker per configuration; asyncio and HTTP-client connections pass through these calls); unconnected UDP, sockets opened in native code, DNS lookups, the Playwright driver, Chromium and the model server were not instrumented. All 555 attempts went to 127.0.0.1, all to the stand-in's port, and every page request that Playwright reported named host 127.0.0.1; WebSockets and browser-internal traffic were not observed. Because the stand-in claims completion at once, the episodes made no browser action beyond the first navigation, never called the vision model and never retrieved documents; memory retrieval returned at least one record in 54 of the 60 memory-enabled episodes. The stand-in always claims completion, so these episodes say nothing about task success. The repository's test suite runs a reduced version of this check (three development tasks, one configuration, memory and retrieval disabled; it asserts loopback hosts, not the port, so a proxy listening on loopback would pass, whereas the released raw log of the 70-episode run shows only the stand-in's port), together with tests that a remote model address is refused and that Chroma telemetry is off; 144 of its 147 tests pass (`python -m pytest`, 2026-10-04, `artifacts/results/pytest_revision.txt`; `backend/` and `tests/` are unchanged since); the 3 failures need live websites or a running local model.

The end-to-end oracle agreed with the intended verdict on all 114 scripted trajectories. The informative cases are the 35 correct solutions of satisfiable tasks (no false negative; 95% interval 0–0.10) and the 34 near misses (no false positive; 0–0.10); the idle trajectories and the solutions of unsatisfiable tasks are negative by construction, and two idle trajectories coincide with their correct solutions. The trajectories were written by the oracle's author, so this bounds the oracle's errors on anticipated behaviors only.

E. End-to-End Evaluation

We have not run the end-to-end evaluation with a language model: the environment used for this paper could not download model weights. Consequently this paper makes no claim about task success, about the gate's effect on success or on false completions of the full agent, about the baselines, or about the contributions of memory, retrieval and the recovery strategies; Table II marks these components as unevaluated. The harness, task set and analysis that produce these measurements are released and run with one command on a machine with Ollama.

IX. Simulation-Based Evaluation

All values in this section are SYNTHETIC unless marked ACTUAL or stated as ASSUMED inputs; rows marked ‡ are PROPOSED components simulated with assumed rates. The synthetic values come from the corrected seeded simulation (v2, post hoc) of Section VII-C, not from running the agent. They show the consequences of the stated assumptions and the measured component behaviour; they do not establish how the deployed agent performs. Every p-value and interval here is conditional on those assumptions.

A. Baselines and Verification (Studies A and B; H1, H2)

Table VI compares four completion rules on the same 100 scenarios of the reported synthetic set (seed 202) at two levels that must not be mixed. At the *decision level*, the planner claims completion in 74 scenarios, 46 of them truly complete at that moment; the four verifiers face the same 74 claims and the same truth, so their decisions are paired. At the *policy level*, an episode's final state may differ between configurations for the same scenario, because a rejected claim returns control to planning and the episode may then finish (or, after a false rejection, never be reported); task success and episode-level false completions are paired outcomes of different policies, not of one ground truth.

H1 (false completions). Episodes end in a false completion 19 times with Φ against 28 without verification (FCR 0.30 against 0.38; discordant pairs 9 and 0; Table VII); basic success detection ends in 24. In the model the direction is fixed by construction (in the code, a continuation after a false rejection could later be accepted on a changed page, which the model omits): Φ can only withhold a claim that would otherwise be accepted, so no scenario can end in a false completion with Φ alone, one discordant cell is always 0, and only the size of the reduction is informative. Across 1,000 regenerated scenario sets, with the derived rates drawn from their posteriors, the reduction averages 0.11 false completions per scenario (2.5–97.5th percentiles 0.05–0.18); because one discordant cell is structurally 0, a McNemar p would only restate the 9 discordant scenarios, so we report this interval instead. Under the stated assumptions the simulation is consistent with H1; it is not empirical confirmation.

H2 (decision reliability). On the 74 claims, Φ decides correctly in 52 (accuracy 0.70, Wilson 0.59–0.79) and accepting every claim in 46 (0.62, 0.51–0.72): Φ is correct alone in 9 claims, all rejections of premature claims, and wrong alone in 3, all false rejections (two of them on scenarios with missing evidence, which Φ rejects at an ASSUMED rate of 0.8; the measured false-rejection rate is 0 of 24) (exact McNemar $p = 0.15$). The difference has the hypothesized direction but is not significant in this set, and across regenerated sets Φ is better at $p < 0.05$ in only 42% (mean accuracy 0.74 against 0.64), so H2 is not supported for Φ at this sample size (74 claims). The proposed enhanced validation reaches 61 of 74 (0.82; against Φ 11 and 2, $p = 0.022$), a difference that follows from its assumed detection rates. At the policy level, the simulated Φ configuration ends with 44 of 100 synthetic scenarios achieved and reported, against 46 without verification (3 only without verification, 1 only with Φ; $p = 0.63$): in the simulation, false rejections cost 3 successes and continuation after a correct rejection recovers 1.

B. Ablation (Study C)

Table VIII removes one component at a time. Removing Φ reproduces the no-verification row. In the simulation, disabling the recovery engine, with the retries before it still in place, lowers synthetic TSR from 0.44 to 0.41 (3 successes lost, none gained; $p = 0.25$) and, across replications, from 0.47 to 0.45; the size of this effect is set by the recovery probabilities of Study E, which rest on assumed per-attempt success rates. Removing memory changes one outcome in each direction and nothing on average. Stored evidence is not ablated: Φ reads the live page, so stored evidence serves the audit trail and does not change decisions.

C. Memory and Retrieval (Study D; H3)

On the synthetic memory corpus the real store returned a relevant record in the top three for each of the 9 queries that had one (recall@3 1.00, MRR 0.93 over those 9; ACTUAL). It has no relevance threshold, however: a query with no relevant memory still returned three records, and for 3 of 10 queries the top record was irrelevant or a *failed* earlier attempt (Table IX). Relevance is labelled by task group and is loose (a search for one place counts as relevant to a search for another), so recall is optimistic, and precision@3 is bounded by the number of relevant records per query; the measured 0.52 is the largest value attainable on this corpus. With a misleading rate set to the measured share of irrelevant top-1 records (3/10; that this share equals the probability of misleading the planner is assumed), the simulated repeated workflows succeed 19 times of 44 with and without memory, so H3 is not supported. With 44 workflows and an assumed gain of 0.08 the study could not have detected an effect of that size, so it is uninformative about H3 rather than evidence against it. The proposed relevance filter (20 of 44) changes the outcome only through its assumed misleading rate.

D. Recovery (Study E; H4)

The real recovery engine classifies a navigation error containing `net::ERR_` as transient, treats an invalid submission as a verification failure and assigns it re-planning, and does not recognize a missing confirmation, which it classifies as unknown (ACTUAL). In the code, action errors, including a planner's request for help, are first retried three times inline and only then passed to the engine; a failed initial navigation is retried three times by the browser executor before it reaches the engine; and a missing confirmation raises no error at all. Simulated along these paths with assumed per-attempt success rates (Table X), the retries before the engine recover 51 of 93 synthetic recoverable failures, and adding the engine raises this to 68 of 93. Missing confirmations are recovered only by continuation after a rejection (2 of 20 with or without the engine), and 9 of them end as false completions. The proposed evidence-guided recovery, which checks an explicit

TABLE VI

SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC) STUDY B ON THE SAME 100 HELD-OUT SYNTHETIC SCENARIOS (CORRECTED MODEL V2). POLICY LEVEL: FINAL OUTCOME OF EACH EPISODE (TP REPORTED AND ACHIEVED, FP REPORTED BUT NOT ACHIEVED, FN ACHIEVED BUT NOT REPORTED, TN NEITHER); THE FINAL STATE CAN DIFFER BETWEEN CONFIGURATIONS BECAUSE A REJECTION RETURNS CONTROL TO PLANNING. DECISION LEVEL: THE VERIFIER'S FIRST ACCEPT/WITHHOLD DECISION ON THE 74 SCENARIOS IN WHICH THE PLANNER CLAIMS COMPLETION (46 TRULY COMPLETE), AGAINST THE TRUE STATE AT THAT CLAIM. WILSON 95% INTERVALS. SYNTHETIC p-VALUES AND INTERVALS ARE CONDITIONAL ON THE SIMULATION ASSUMPTIONS; THEY ARE NOT EMPIRICAL TESTS OF THE AGENT. ‡NOT IMPLEMENTED (PROPOSED).

Configuration	TP	FP	FN	TN	TSR	FCR	FRR	Decision TP/FP/FN/TN	Decision acc.
No verification	46	28	3	23	46/100 [0.37,0.56]	28/74 [0.28,0.49]	3/49 [0.02,0.17]	46/28/0/0	46/74 [0.51,0.72]
Basic success detection	43	24	6	27	43/100 [0.34,0.53]	24/67 [0.25,0.48]	6/49 [0.06,0.24]	43/24/3/4	47/74 [0.52,0.74]
Evidence-gated (Φ)	44	19	6	31	44/100 [0.35,0.54]	19/63 [0.20,0.42]	6/50 [0.06,0.24]	43/19/3/9	52/74 [0.59,0.79]
Enhanced validation‡	46	8	8	38	46/100 [0.37,0.56]	8/54 [0.08,0.27]	8/54 [0.08,0.27]	41/8/5/20	61/74 [0.72,0.89]

TABLE VII

SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC) PAIRED COMPARISONS WITH Φ ON THE SAME SYNTHETIC SCENARIOS (V2, POST HOC). DISCORDANT PAIRS b/c (b: ONLY THE OTHER CONFIGURATION; c: ONLY Φ). FC: EPISODE ENDS IN A FALSE COMPLETION (100 SCENARIOS); ΔFC: FALSE COMPLETIONS PER SCENARIO OF THE OTHER CONFIGURATION MINUS Φ, MEAN [2.5–97.5TH PERCENTILES] OVER 1000 REGENERATED SETS WITH RATES DRAWN FROM THEIR BETA POSTERIORS. DEC.: FIRST DECISION CORRECT (74 CLAIMS), EXACT MCNEMAR p. SUCC.: TASK ACHIEVED AND REPORTED (100 SCENARIOS), EXACT MCNEMAR p. MC ACC.: MEAN DECISION ACCURACY OVER THE REGENERATED SETS. §ONE CELL IS 0 BY CONSTRUCTION OF THE MODEL (Φ ONLY WITHHOLDS CLAIMS THAT NO VERIFICATION ACCEPTS; ENHANCED VALIDATION WITHHOLDS EVERY CLAIM Φ WITHHOLDS), SO NO MCNEMAR p IS GIVEN: IT WOULD ONLY RESTATE b OR c. ¶ZERO CELL FROM THE NESTING OF BASIC DETECTION WITHIN Φ AT THE POINT-ESTIMATE RATES; IN THE REGENERATED SETS, WHERE THE TWO RATES ARE DRAWN INDEPENDENTLY, Φ-ONLY FALSE COMPLETIONS OCCUR IN 39% OF SETS. SYNTHETIC p-VALUES AND INTERVALS ARE CONDITIONAL ON THE SIMULATION ASSUMPTIONS; THEY ARE NOT EMPIRICAL TESTS OF THE AGENT.

Config.	FC b/c	ΔFC [MC]	Dec. b/c	p	Succ. b/c	p	MC acc.
None	9/0§	+0.11 [+0.05,+0.18]	3/9	0.15	3/1	0.63	.64
Basic	5/0¶	+0.06 [+0.00,+0.12]	0/5	0.063¶	0/1	1.0¶	.66
Φ	ref.		ref.		ref.		.74
Enhanced‡	0/11§	-0.08 [-0.14,-0.03]	11/2	0.022	4/2	0.69	.79

TABLE VIII

SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC) STUDY C: ONE COMPONENT REMOVED AT A TIME, ON THE SAME 100 SCENARIOS (POLICY LEVEL). EACH ROW IS A SIMULATED CONFIGURATION, NOT A RUN OF THE IMPLEMENTATION; EACH CORRESPONDS TO A SWITCH IN THE CODE (`VERIFICATION_MODE`, `ENABLE_MEMORY`, `ENABLE_RECOVERY`). §AS IN THE CODE, DISABLING THE RECOVERY ENGINE LEAVES THE THREE INLINE RETRIES OF THE VERIFICATION NODE IN PLACE. REMOVAL OF STORED EVIDENCE IS NOT SIMULATED: Φ READS THE LIVE PAGE, SO STORED EVIDENCE AFFECTS THE AUDIT TRAIL, NOT DECISIONS (CODE BEHAVIOUR). SUCC.: PAIRED TASK-SUCCESS DISCORDANCE b/c WITH Φ AND EXACT MCNEMAR p. MC: MEANS OVER 1000 REGENERATED SETS. SYNTHETIC p-VALUES AND INTERVALS ARE CONDITIONAL ON THE SIMULATION ASSUMPTIONS; THEY ARE NOT EMPIRICAL TESTS OF THE AGENT.

Configuration	TP (of 100)	FCR	FRR	F1	Succ. b/c; p	MC TSR	MC FCR
Full (Φ)	44 [.35,.54]	.302	.120	.779	ref.	0.47	0.25
– Φ	46 [.37,.56]	.378	.061	.748	3/1; 0.63	0.47	0.36
– memory	44 [.35,.54]	.312	.120	.772	1/1; 1.0	0.47	0.25
– recovery engine§	41 [.32,.51]	.305	.128	.774	0/3; 0.25	0.45	0.25

TABLE IX

STUDY D, MEMORY AND RETRIEVAL. UPPER BLOCK ACTUAL (REAL STORE, SYNTHETIC RECORDS); LOWER BLOCK SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC). P(MISLEADING): PROBABILITY THAT THE RETRIEVED CONTEXT MISLEADS THE PLANNER; FOR THE STORE IT IS SET TO THE MEASURED SHARE OF IRRELEVANT TOP-1 RECORDS (DERIVED; THAT THIS SHARE IS THE PROBABILITY OF MISLEADING THE PLANNER IS ASSUMED); FOR THE FILTER IT IS AN ASSUMED INPUT, SO ANY EFFECT OF THE FILTER FOLLOWS FROM THAT ASSUMPTION. WITH 44 REPEATED WORKFLOWS THE STUDY CANNOT DETECT AN EFFECT OF THE ASSUMED SIZE (GAIN 0.08, LOSS 0.10). ‡NOT IMPLEMENTED.

ACTUAL retrieval, real store, 22 synthetic records; 9 queries with a relevant record			
Precision@3 / Recall@3 / MRR	0.52	1.00	0.93
Top-1 irrelevant or failed (all 10 queries)	3/10		
SYNTHETIC repeated workflows (n=44)			
Configuration	TSR	FCR	P(misleading)
Memory disabled	19/44 [0.30,0.58]	.387	–
Memory enabled	19/44 [0.30,0.58]	.367	0.30 (der.)
Relevance-filtered‡	20/44 [0.32,0.60]	.355	0.10 (assumed)

confirmation postcondition, recovers 87 and leaves 2 false completions (19 scenarios recovered only by it, none only by the engine); this is a consequence of its assumed success rates, not evidence for H4. In the simulation the engine spends 174 attempts on permanent failures, the guided variant 162.

E. Verification Overhead (Study F; H5)

Φ takes a median of 5.2 ms on an ordinary page of the self-hosted sites and 26.8 ms on the constructed gate states; a screenshot 61 ms and DOM extraction 76 ms (ACTUAL, Table XI). In the simulation, with an assumed median of 3 s per model call on a CPU, inference takes 80% of an episode and the checks of Φ 0.1%. The mean episode is nevertheless 2.6% longer with Φ (20.2 against 19.7 s), because each rejected claim costs one further planning step (planner call, DOM extraction, click, three screenshots; assumed), and Φ times are resampled from the slower gate-state measurements; a model self-check adds 14% (22.4 s; a cost-only figure, since the simulated self-check accepts every claim). At 1.5 s or 6 s per call the median episode under Φ takes 10.0 s or 36.8 s. H5 is consistent with the simulation: the rule itself is cheap, and its cost is in false rejections and the re-planning that rejections cause.

F. Robustness and Sensitivity (Study H)

The advantage of verification depends on how often the planner claims completion prematurely, which is unmeasured (Fig. 3): at $\pi = 0.3$ the FCR of Φ is 0.14 against 0.21 without verification, at $\pi = 0.95$ 0.32 against 0.45, while FRR stays near 0.14 against 0.08. Halving the derived detection rates

TABLE X

SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC) STUDY E: 120 FAILURE SCENARIOS, 20 PER MODE; 27 DRAWN AS PERMANENT (25% EXPECTED), NONE OF THEM A MISSING CONFIRMATION. ENTRY PATHS AND STRATEGY SEQUENCES FOLLOW THE CODE FOR THE FIRST FAILURE OF A TASK (EACH SCENARIO HAS ONE FAILURE; IN THE CODE LATER FAILURES FIND THE SHARED RETRY COUNTER PARTLY USED): ACTION ERRORS, INCLUDING A PLANNER'S REQUEST FOR HELP, ARE RETRIED THREE TIMES INLINE BEFORE THE ENGINE IS CALLED; A FAILED INITIAL NAVIGATION IS RETRIED THREE TIMES BY THE BROWSER EXECUTOR AND THEN PASSED TO THE ENGINE; A MISSING CONFIRMATION RAISES NO ERROR AND IS HANDLED ONLY BY REJECTION AND CONTINUATION. §THE RETRIES BEFORE THE ENGINE REMAIN. PER-ATTEMPT SUCCESS RATES ARE ASSUMED (PROPOSED FOR THE GUIDED VARIANT), SO DIFFERENCES BETWEEN ROWS FOLLOW FROM THEM. DETECTED: FAILURE NOTICED; FC: UNDETECTED MISSING CONFIRMATIONS REPORTED COMPLETE; UNNEC.: ATTEMPTS ON PERMANENT FAILURES; ATT.: MEAN ATTEMPTS. ‡NOT IMPLEMENTED.

Recovery	Detected	Recovered	FC	Unnec.	Att.
Engine off§	111/120 [0.86,0.96]	51/93 [0.45,0.65]	9	81	2.08
Engine on (as impl.; sim.)	111/120 [0.86,0.96]	68/93 [0.63,0.81]	9	174	3.25
Evidence-guided‡	118/120 [0.94,1.00]	87/93 [0.87,0.97]	2	162	3.17

Recovered / recoverable by mode (engine off; engine on; guided)
nav. 12; 16; 16 / 16, time-out 9; 12; 13 / 14, missing el. 9; 13; 14 / 15
invalid sub. 9; 13; 14 / 14, unexp. state 10; 12; 13 / 14, missing conf. 2; 2; 17 / 20

TABLE XI

STUDY F, VERIFICATION OVERHEAD. UPPER BLOCK ACTUAL; P95 IS THE ORDER STATISTIC OF RANK $\mathrm{round}(0.95(n-1))+1$. *83 DECISIONS ON THE CONSTRUCTED GATE STATES, EACH THE MEDIAN OF 20 REPETITIONS (SECTION VIII-C), MEASURED ON 2026-10-04 ON A 2.1 GHZ MACHINE; THE OTHER ROWS ON 2026-10-23 ON A 2.8 GHZ MACHINE, SO THE TWO Φ ROWS ARE NOT DIRECTLY COMPARABLE. LOWER BLOCK SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC), BUILT FROM THE ACTUAL COMPONENT SAMPLES AND AN ASSUMED INFERENCE TIME, WITH RE-PLANNING AFTER REJECTIONS AND RECOVERY ATTEMPTS INCLUDED; THE TWO BLOCKS ARE NOT COMBINED INTO ONE CLAIM. INFERENCE TAKES 80% OF SYNTHETIC EPISODE TIME UNDER Φ, EVIDENCE SCREENSHOTS 4.1%. ‡NOT IMPLEMENTED.

ACTUAL component latency (ms), local sites, 30 repetitions

Operation	median	p95
navigate	17.1	24.9
click + load	65.2	106.2
fill	12.5	17.4
DOM extraction	76.4	105.6
screenshot (evidence)	61.3	93.6
Φ on a site page	5.2	6.9
Φ on gate states*	26.8	30.3

SYNTHETIC episode time (s), inference median 3.0 s assumed

Configuration	median	mean	verif. share
No verification	18.1	19.7	0.00%
Evidence-gated (Φ)	18.9	20.2	0.11%
LLM self-verification	21.2	22.4	12.21%
Φ + model check‡	22.6	24.0	14.13%

of Φ raises its FCR from 0.25 to 0.30, about halfway to no verification (0.36); missing evidence raises FRR (0.09 to 0.22) because the simulated Φ rejects a claim on an unreadable page with assumed probability 0.8; more action failures lower TSR; and a higher rate of finishing after a rejection raises the TSR of Φ from 0.45 to 0.50 (Table XII).

X. DISCUSSION

a) What the evidence supports: On constructed states the gate withholds 41% of unsatisfied held-out states and is correct on significantly more held-out states than a dispatch-only rule,

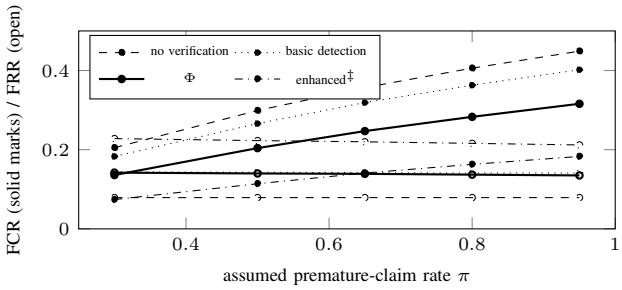


Fig. 3. SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC) Study H: mean FCR and FRR over 300 regenerated scenario sets per point as the assumed rate at which the planner claims completion of an unfinished task varies. Stricter verification lowers FCR at every rate and raises FRR; its FCR advantage grows with π. ‡Not implemented.

TABLE XII

SIMULATION-BASED (SYNTHETIC) STUDY H: ROBUSTNESS OF THE EVIDENCE-GATED CONFIGURATION (MEANS OVER 300 REGENERATED SETS PER ROW, DRAWN FROM A RANDOM STREAM SEPARATE FROM THE 1,000-SET MONTE CARLO OF TABLE VII, SO THE UNPERTURBED ROWS DIFFER SLIGHTLY FROM IT). WITHOUT VERIFICATION FCR STAYS AT 0.36 AT EVERY CONTINUATION RATE.

Varied factor (Φ)	FCR	FRR	TSR
Φ detection $\times 0.5$	0.30	0.14	0.46
Φ detection $\times 1.0$	0.25	0.14	0.47
Φ detection $\times 1.5$	0.19	0.13	0.49
missing evidence 0%	0.23	0.09	0.52
missing evidence 8%	0.25	0.14	0.47
missing evidence 20%	0.29	0.22	0.39
action failure rate 0.1	0.25	0.14	0.50
action failure rate 0.25	0.25	0.14	0.47
action failure rate 0.4	0.25	0.14	0.44
finish after rejection 0.1	0.26	0.14	0.45
finish after rejection 0.35	0.25	0.14	0.47
finish after rejection 0.6	0.24	0.13	0.50

at tens of milliseconds and no model call; its coverage of new phrasings, not its cost, is its binding limit, and some of its defects appeared only inside the live verification node. The evidence does not show that the agent completes tasks. The simulation (Section IX) adds no empirical support; it shows that under the stated assumptions the benefit of the gate depends on the unmeasured premature-claim rate and is paid for in false rejections.

b) Rules and model judges: The held-out results argue against extending hand-written web rules indefinitely: each rule is keyed to the wording it was written for. Model-based judges [7], [26] cover broader goals but add inference cost and are models judging models [9]. The self-verification baseline in our harness will measure this alternative on the same tasks. We expect the two to be complementary—exact postconditions where the environment exposes structured state, a judge as a second opinion where it does not—with both inputs kept as evidence.

XI. SAFETY, PRIVACY AND AUTONOMY

a) Threat model: The user and the host are trusted; content the agent reads is not. We consider (i) instructions injected through web pages [31]; (ii) high-impact actions

without consent, such as posting, sending, purchasing or deleting; (iii) exposure of credentials and of screenshots that show sensitive data; and (iv) disclosure of user data to parties other than the site the user asked the agent to use, in particular to a model provider. A compromised host, browser or model is out of scope.

b) Privacy property: We call the system privacy-preserving in this sense: *by default the model client sends prompts and screenshots only to a model server on the loopback interface, and the code writes task records, memory and evidence only to local files.* The model client refuses a non-loopback endpoint unless the user sets an explicit override, Chroma telemetry is off, and in 70 harness episodes with a stand-in model server the agent's Python processes attempted no connection to a non-loopback address (Section VIII-D). The property does not cover: what the loopback model server does with a request (Ollama cloud models or a local tunnel forward it off the machine) and the server's own traffic; prompt context drawn from memory and retrieved documents, which goes to whatever endpoint is configured; data the user asks the agent to enter on a website, which reaches that website; the user-invoked search-engine fallback, which sends the query to that provider; model weights and Chroma's default embedding model, which are downloaded once; proxy environment variables, which the HTTP client honours, so a configured proxy can receive model requests even for a loopback address; the monitoring UI, which loads web fonts from Google; and unencrypted local storage. The scope of the egress test is given in Section VIII-D; local file storage is established by code inspection.

Table XIII summarizes each surface, the control in the code, the evidence for it and the residual risk.

c) Autonomy and what the implementation provides: The agent acts only in the browser and exposes no file, process or command action. Before navigation, a task whose parsed action is posting, e-mailing, purchasing, deleting or transferring, or whose risk level is high or critical, waits for the user's approval; intent and risk come from the request alone. Bot checks stop the task for the user. A sanitizer replaces 17 instruction-override, delimiter, exfiltration and role-manipulation patterns in element text. The service listens only on the loopback interface, and each successful model completion is logged with destination and payload sizes (failed attempts and model-list calls are not, and the log can be disabled).

d) What it does not provide: The sanitizer is a fixed denylist, which systematic evaluations find insufficient [32]; titles, extracted text and memory are not filtered. The action label and risk level that trigger approval come from a small model and are decided once per task, so an injected instruction that steers the planner to submit a form mid-task is not gated. The API on 127.0.0.1 has no authentication and checks neither the Host header nor the Origin of WebSocket connections, so a web page open on the same machine, including one the agent visits, may be able to reach it (DNS rebinding, cross-site WebSocket access) and read task events, records and evidence screenshots, subject to the browser's local-network protections; typed text is stored in clear, and screenshots are not redacted. We make no security claim. The browser hides common automation signals; we consider this acceptable only for a personal assistant acting at human pace on its user's requests, and deployments should disable it where a site's terms prohibit automated access.

TABLE XIII
PRIVACY AND SECURITY ASSESSMENT (STUDY G, ANALYTICAL). EVIDENCE: E EGRESS TEST, C CODE INSPECTION, T UNIT TEST; – NONE.

Surface	Control in the code	Evid.	Residual risk
Model inference	loopback endpoint enforced; override must be explicit	E, T	user override, or a loopback server that forwards requests (Ollama cloud models, a tunnel), sends prompts and screenshots off the machine; E used a stand-in server
Memory, task data	SQLite and Chroma on local disk; telemetry off	C, T	not encrypted; default file permissions; traces keep the first 500 characters of each prompt and response
Websites	none: the planner may follow links to any site	C	data the agent types reaches that site
Browser traffic	none in the agent; the test harness logs page-request URLs	E	Chromium background traffic, WebSockets and DNS not observed
Screenshots	stored in the local evidence folder	C	not redacted; may show account data
Retention	no deletion policy	C	evidence, traces, database and memory grow without bound
Local API	bound to 127.0.0.1; no authentication, Host or WebSocket Origin check	C	web pages on the same machine may read task events and evidence
Monitoring UI	loads web fonts from Google	C	opening it contacts fonts.googleapis.com
High-risk actions	approval before posting, sending, purchasing, deleting	C, T	model-assigned label; once per task
Injected text	17-pattern sanitizer on element text	C, T	denylist; titles and memory unfiltered

XII. LIMITATIONS AND THREATS TO VALIDITY

a) Internal validity: The same AI agent wrote all gate states and labels and designed the fixes on the design states, so the design results are optimistic. Held-out 2 was frozen before testing, but its author knew the gate's rules; independent states and labels would give a less biased estimate. The live mode stands in for the planner with empty or generic reasoning, not model output.

b) External validity: All gate measurements use small, static pages served offline; real pages are larger and change, and latency will grow. The locality test used a stand-in model server and self-hosted pages and instrumented only the Python processes, so it does not show what a real model server, Chromium or the desktop client send off the machine. The end-to-end harness uses fictional, self-hosted sites, which avoids memorized answers and site drift but is simpler than real sites.

c) Statistical power: The sets are small: with 22 unsatisfied held-out 2 states the 95% interval of the withheld share spans 0.23–0.61, and the ablation cannot separate conjuncts that change one or two decisions.

d) Simulation validity: The simulated results follow from assumptions about planner behaviour, action failures and memory that no measurement supports; paired p-values describe the

synthetic sample, not the agent. The measured inputs come from small constructed sets (54 held-out gate states, of which 27 unsatisfied and 27 satisfied; 10 memory queries; 6 failure messages), and the proposed components are simulated by assumed rates. The reported model (v2) was revised twice after its first results were known (after a methodology audit, and again after a final review of the recovery paths), so it is not pre-registered; the corrections bring it closer to the code and moved the results in favour of Φ, but the choice of what to correct was made with the results in view. Its sample size (100 scenarios) is chosen, so synthetic significance is partly a matter of that choice. It can show which assumptions matter (Study H), not which outcome will occur.

e) Construct validity: FCR and FRR depend on the oracle. The browser predicate is keyed to request wording, so its coverage depends on how users phrase requests; when no keyword fires, it reduces to an error check.

f) System limitations: Planning with 1.5B–7B models is weak; vision-grounded clicks are not individually checked; three of the four recovery strategies (retry, alternative selector, replan) behave identically, as ordinary re-planning; evidence files carry no integrity protection.

XIII. Future Work

The first step is to run the released end-to-end protocol with local models, which answers the open questions on task success, the gate's effect on the full agent, the self-verification baseline, memory and recovery. For the gate, we will derive per-step postconditions from the planner's expected outcomes instead of request wording, add a local vision-language judge as a second opinion, and have the held-out states labelled independently. Beyond the browser, the computer backend of Appendix A would extend the gate to desktop applications, files and processes, behind deterministic pre-action permission checks.

XIV. Conclusion

Agentic Pilot is a local browser agent built on the rule that an executed action is not a completed task: it may report completion only when a predicate over the observed page holds, and it keeps the inputs of that decision as evidence. The paper offers three kinds of evidence, which should be read separately. *Measured at component level:* in the agent's real verification node, called directly on constructed states with stubbed I/O, the predicate withheld most premature completions on the states it was designed on and 41% on states frozen before testing, at a median of 27 ms and no model call, so its coverage of new phrasings, not its cost, is the limit; by default the model client connects only to a loopback endpoint, and in 70 episodes with a stand-in model server the agent's Python processes connected only to loopback addresses, which says nothing about where a real model server sends a request. *Simulated, conditional on stated assumptions:* the gate's benefit depends on how often the planner claims completion prematurely and is paid for in false rejections. Component measurements, not the simulation, show that memory retrieval has no relevance threshold and that recovery does not recognize a missing confirmation; the simulated gains of a relevance filter and a confirmation check follow from their assumed rates and are not evidence for them. *Not executed:* an end-to-end evaluation with a language model; the harness for it is released with an oracle validated on scripted trajectories, and its results will decide the questions the simulation can only frame.

Acknowledgment

An AI system (Anthropic's Claude, run as a set of coding, analysis and writing agents) did most of the technical work reported here, at the direction of the author: it analyzed the source code; implemented the agent fixes and the locality enforcement of Section V; wrote the constructed gate states and their oracle labels, and the end-to-end tasks, sites and oracle; designed and implemented the simulation and proposed its assumed parameter values; ran all reported experiments; performed the methodology audits and the recomputation checks of Section VII-C (the agents named there are AI agents, not people); compiled and checked the references; and drafted the text. No person has relabelled the gate states. The author set the research goals and requirements, directed the revisions and takes full responsibility for the content.

Appendix A
Computer Backend (Design, Not Implemented)

The repository contains a desktop executor that wraps PyAutoGUI and psutil, a text-file helper and a file-existence predicate. None is connected to the control loop: no node, action type or API route calls them, and the file helper does not confine paths. The rest of this appendix is a design.

a) Observation and grounding: The backend would observe the foreground window through its accessibility tree (Windows UI Automation, macOS Accessibility, AT-SPI) into a manifest shaped like the DOM manifest, falling back to a vision model on a window screenshot. File and process actions are grounded in typed state (paths, hashes, process identity).

b) Postconditions and permission tiers: Each mutating action carries exact postconditions (Table XIV) captured with before/after values. Because many local actions cannot be undone, a postcondition checked afterwards is no protection on its own, so an `action_gate` node between planning and execution would compute a tier from the concrete action: T0 (read-only) runs freely; T1 (reversible, with a recorded inverse) runs automatically only if the user enabled it; T2 (destructive) and T3 (network-capable programs, credentials) always need approval bound to a hash of the exact action. Paths outside allow-listed roots, inline interpreters and privilege elevation would be refused. A design in which untrusted content cannot change the control flow [37] is a stronger alternative.

Appendix B
End-to-End Task Set

The 40 tasks (`benchmarks/e2e/tasks.json`) are distributed as follows (development/test): extraction 2/8, form submission 2/7, multi-step 1/5, navigation 2/2, search 1/2,

TABLE XIV
COMPLETION POSTCONDITIONS BY ENVIRONMENT AND THEIR STATUS IN THE CODE. IMPL.: IMPLEMENTED AND USED BY THE AGENT; UNIT: IMPLEMENTED AND UNIT-TESTED, NOT CALLED BY THE AGENT; PROP.: PROPOSED DESIGN. h_0: HASH BEFORE THE ACTION; (pid, t_c): PROCESS ID AND CREATION TIME.

Env.	Example postcondition	Status
Browser	no error or sign-in page; results page for the quoted query; requested text present; answer mentions the goal; no pending step	Impl.
Browser	bot-check page detected ⇒ BLOCKED	Impl.
File	path exists and size $\geq n$	Unit
File	created / overwritten: sha256 = sha256(content); moved: source absent and sha256(dst) = h_0(src); trashed: path absent and trash entry present	Prop.
Process	launched: (pid, t_c) alive; terminated: (pid, t_c) gone within a timeout	Prop.
Window	foreground title matches; window with title exists	Prop.
Desktop UI	accessibility value of a control equals the input; control state contains *checked*	Prop.
Read-only	workspace manifest (paths, sizes, mtimes) unchanged	Prop.

TABLE XV
END-TO-END EVALUATION DESIGN (IMPLEMENTED IN BENCHMARKS/E2E, NOT YET RUN WITH A MODEL). EACH CONFIGURATION CHANGES ONE FACTOR OF THE FULL SYSTEM; ALL USE THE SAME TASKS, MODEL, SAMPLING AND BUDGET.

Configuration	Change	Question
`full`	–	task success, FCR, FRR, cost
`no_verification`	completion accepted wherever Φ would be evaluated	baseline (a); gain and overhead of Φ
`self_verification`	planner model judges its own completion	baseline (b)
`gate_without_`c	conjunct c removed	per-evidence ablation
`no_memory`	memory and RAG off	contribution of memory
`no_evidence`	no per-action execution records	traceability
`no_recovery`	engine off; inline retries remain	contribution of recovery
`recovery_`s`_only`	strategy s pinned	per-strategy recovery
`single_model`	routing off	routing
`vision_only_grounding`	no element list	grounding

text entry 1/2, unsatisfiable 1/4; tiers 1–4 contain 3/6, 4/11, 3/12 and 0/1 tasks. The test split uses all five sites; the notes site appears only there. The harness (`run_e2e.py`) takes the split, the number of trials and a list of the configurations of Table XV; the analysis script (`analyze_e2e.py`) writes result tables with Wilson intervals, McNemar tests and bootstrap intervals.

APPENDIX C
SIMULATION PARAMETERS AND PROVENANCE

Table XVI lists the parameters of the simulation with their class; modelling choices that are not single values (latency structure, attempt caps) are listed at the end of the table. The assumed premature-claim rate (0.65) and finish-after-rejection rate (0.35) are swept in Study H to show how far the results depend on them, and the rates that decide the gate's behaviour are derived from the held-out gate states, not from the design states on which the gate was tuned. The per-scenario data (`scenarios.csv`, `recovery_scenarios.csv`), the results, the evidence ledger with the source and class of every simulated number, and the v1 validation report are in `benchmarks/simulation/out/heldout_v2/` (v1: `out/heldout_v1/`, identical to `out/heldout/`, which the v1 decision analysis reads) and `artifacts/results/`. The v2 outputs and the simulation tables are regenerated by `python -m benchmarks.simulation.simulate_v2` and `make_tables`, and the whole chain, including the gate statistics, the egress summary and the paper, by `make reproduce-paper` with the package versions of `requirements-paper.lock`; the v1 recomputation script is `independent_validator.py` (an AI-written arithmetic check, not an independent replication).

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TABLE XVI

SIMULATION PARAMETERS OF THE CORRECTED MODEL V2 AND THEIR PROVENANCE (BENCHMARKS/SIMULATION/PARAMS.JSON, SIMULATE_V2.PY). DERIVED GATE RATES USE $(k+0.5)/(n+1)$ ON THE HELD-OUT GATE STATES (THE MISLEADING-RETRIEVAL RATE IS THE RAW SHARE $3/10$); MONTE CARLO SETS DRAW THEM FROM BETA$(k+0.5, n-k+0.5)$.

Parameter	Value	Class
Scenarios per set; dev / held-out seed; MC sets	100; 101 / 202; 1000	ASSUMED (design choice)
Task categories (nav., search, form, data entry, extraction, multi-step)	0.15 / 0.15 / 0.20 / 0.15 / 0.20 / 0.15	ASSUMED
Outcome classes (successful, incomplete, incorrect, missing, contradictory, stale, ambiguous)	0.40 / 0.15 / 0.12 / 0.08 / 0.08 / 0.07 / 0.10	ASSUMED
P(task truly complete | class), same order	1.0 / 0.0 / 0.0 / 0.5 / 0.5 / 0.3 / 0.5	ASSUMED
Planner claims completion: if complete / if not (π)	0.92 / 0.65	ASSUMED
Φ withhold rate on unsatisfied states, by task category	navi. 0.36, sear. 0.50, form. 0.50, data. 0.38, extr. 0.07, mult. 0.63	DERIVED (mapping ASSUMED)
Basic detection withhold rate, same	navi. 0.36, sear. 0.10, form. 0.07, data. 0.13, extr. 0.07, mult. 0.13	DERIVED (mapping ASSUMED)
False rejection: Φ / basic	0/24 $\rightarrow$ 0.02 / 0.02 (satisfied states of the mapped categories; bot-check pages excluded)	DERIVED
Ambiguous-class detection factor	0.5	ASSUMED
Verifier rejects when evidence is missing (Φ and basic)	0.8	ASSUMED
Enhanced: extra catch / extra false rej. / contradiction rej.	0.5 / 0.05 / 0.7	PROPOSED
Finish after rejection (continuation is verified again)	0.35	ASSUMED
Action failure; recovered with / without engine	0.25; 0.66 / 0.49	ASSUMED; SYNTHETIC (Study E)
Repeated workflows; memory gain / loss	0.4; 0.08 / 0.1	ASSUMED
Misleading retrieval: store / filtered	0.30 (raw k/n) / 0.1	DERIVED (mapping ASSUMED) / PROPOSED
Recovery: permanent share; attempts	0.25; 3 inline + up to 3 engine; 3 executor + up to 6 engine (navigation)	ASSUMED; code
Recovery entry paths; strategy sequences	code (Table X)	code inspection; ACTUAL
Recovery success per attempt	0.10–0.45 (re-plan), 0.05–0.35 (vision); guided 0.35–0.55	ASSUMED / PROPOSED
Missing-confirmation detection: retry / guided	0.63 / 0.9	DERIVED via ASSUMED proxy / PROPOSED
Steps per episode by category (same order as above)	2 / 3 / 5 / 3 / 3 / 6	ASSUMED
Inference time per call (median, log-sd)	3.0 s, 0.5	ASSUMED
Browser, DOM, screenshot latency; Φ latency	resampled from site measurements; from the gate-state measurements	ACTUAL
Category mapping (simulated to gate categories)	Section VII-C	ASSUMED
Executor and inline retries	scored at the re-plan success rate	ASSUMED
Missing confirmation after rejection	one continuation attempt at the finish-after-rejection rate	ASSUMED
Episode time structure	1 planner call, DOM extraction and action per step; 3 screenshots per step, 2 at completion; 1 extra step per rejection; recovery attempts from Study E	ASSUMED (code-based)
Self-check baseline	one model call per claim; never rejects (cost only)	ASSUMED
Monte Carlo; sensitivity grid	1000 sets, assumed values and recovery probabilities fixed; 300 sets per point	design

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